

system, including all flavours of Unix, the Mac OS, and the latest versions of Windows.

Throughput

A general term used when defining how much data is going how quickly over a particular transport medium, such as a wireless network or a phone line. When your modem says it can transfer data at a rate of 56 Kbps, for instance, it is describing its maximum throughput level.

Twisted Pair

Telephone companies commonly run twisted pairs of copper wires to each customer household. The pairs consist of two insulated copper wires twisted into a spiral pattern. Although originally designed for plain old telephone service (POTS), these wires can carry data as well as voice. New services such as ISDN and ADSL also use twisted-pair copper connections.

UPnP

Universal Plug and Play. Universal Plug and Play is a networking architecture developed by a consortium of companies to ensure easy connectivity between products from different vendors. UPnP devices should be able to connect to a network automatically, handling identification and other processes on the fly. The standards developed by the UPnP Forum are media, platform, and device-independent.

UWB

Ultra Wide Band. An emerging wireless technology that sends signals in extremely short pulses over a wide swath of the radio frequency spectrum. The technology has numerous advantages. Because the power required to send these pulses is very low, the signal can pass through doors and other obstacles, such as the ground, that would reflect a higher-powered signal; also, UWB devices don't need a lot of juice to operate. The brevity of each signal pulse, measured in billions per second, is very hard to detect, giving it some intrinsic security.